

Where we stopped

LAST WEEK

A pet project became a functional port supporting MC68000 / MC68010 port on stock QEMU: threads, interrupts, exceptions, the timer, TLS, logging, the shell, and C++ workloads supported.

The first upstream scope still deliberately narrow.

2 CPUs

**MC68000 + MC68010
stock QEMU virt**

953

**runnable test
configurations**

8,006

**passing test cases
in the frozen run**

m68k is niche, but actively maintained

TWELVE MONTHS TO 8 AUG 2026

Both Linux and NetBSD show current engineering activity around m68k.

Counts are maintenance evidence—not user counts, and not directly comparable.

Linux

82 non-merge commits · 35 authors

1,928 linux-m68k messages

Includes automated reports

NetBSD

251 commits · 12 authors

77 mailing list messages

New hb68k port · custom 68010

Three prerequisite PRs are already public

Zephyr #113320

Multilevel IRQ layout

2 approvals

Checks green

Older review state remains

Zephyr #115160

Flagged-list alignment

2 approvals

No failed checks

Waiting for merge

SDK-NG #1152

m68k toolchain

48 / 48 checks green

Formal review pending

Upstream prerequisite

MERGEABLE

AWAITING MERGE

REVIEW PENDING

Separate generic fixes

PROPOSED REVIEW SHAPE

Five Zephyr merge units plus one external SDK prerequisite.

Unit	Commits	Scope	Review	Current state
Multilevel IRQ	1-2	Zephyr #113320	Separate	Public · green
k_queue	3	Alignment + test	Separate	Next PR
Flagged list	4	Zephyr #115160	Separate	Awaiting merge
Logging	5	Alignment + RX test	Separate	Next PR
m68k port	6-22	Core + drivers + QEMU	Together	Runnable unit
SDK	external	sdk-ng #1152	Prerequisite	48 / 48 green

A realistic six-to-twelve-month path

AUG 2026

NOV

JAN 2027

MAY

AUG

AUG-NOV · close public prerequisites

**NOV-DEC ·
rebase + publish
v3**

**JAN-MAY · review + CI +
docs**

MAY-AUG · contingency

6-12 MONTHS · planned upstream review horizon

Guiding requested from the WG

Four decisions define the integration path.

I am not asking for every implementation detail today. I am asking for the review units, reference target, support bar, ownership expectation, and a planning horizon.

If there is no strong objection, I will continue with the generic prerequisites first and prepare the runnable port in this shape.

- ④ **Review shape**
- ④ **QEMU or hardware gate?**
- ④ **Minimum permanent CI**
- ④ **One maintainer or two?**

M68K
NEXT STEP

A narrow port with a landing path

QEMU-first
Generic fixes on their merits
6-12-month review horizon

12'